contains *headers* with metadata about the request, and optionally includes a *body* payload of data.

By default, HTTP requests are unencrypted; they're plain-text files being sent over the internet. Anyone on the same network as a user (such as someone using the same public Wi-Fi in a coffee shop) can read the requests and responses sent back and forth. Attackers can even modify the requests or responses as they're in transit, as shown in figure 28.1.

